

UI/UX Design Specification

1. Design Goal

The platform should feel like a modern, trustworthy, peaceful, and deeply respectful digital space for learning about Sanatan Dharma.

The design should avoid two extremes:

- Looking like a generic corporate education website
- Looking overly decorative, cluttered, or stereotypically religious

The desired visual balance is:

Modern digital product + subtle Indian spiritual identity

2. Core UX Principles

The website should follow these experience principles:

- Easy for beginners
 - Fast to understand
 - Calm and uncluttered
 - Source transparency
 - Mobile-first
 - Clear content hierarchy
 - Bilingual from the beginning
 - Accessible
 - Consistent
 - Respectful of religious diversity
 - Focused on learning, not distraction
-

3. Visual Personality

The visual identity should feel:

- Calm
- Sacred
- Warm
- Intelligent
- Trustworthy

- Premium
- Modern
- Indian
- Educational

The website should not feel loud, flashy, or entertainment-focused.

4. Design Direction

Recommended design theme:

Modern Indian Spiritual

This means:

- Clean layouts
- Large readable typography
- Soft backgrounds
- Subtle traditional motifs
- Strong content cards
- Minimal animation
- Elegant Sanskrit presentation
- Warm visual tones
- High-quality illustrations or photography

Traditional design elements should be used sparingly.

5. Color Direction

A recommended starting palette:

Primary

Deep saffron or muted orange

Used for:

- Main buttons
- Selected tabs
- Highlights
- Active navigation

Secondary

Deep maroon or warm brown

Used for:

- Important titles
- Secondary accents
- Traditional visual elements

Background

Warm cream or off-white

Used for:

- Main page backgrounds
- Reading areas
- Cards

Dark Text

Charcoal or very dark brown

Used for:

- Body text
- Titles
- Navigation

Accent

Muted gold

Used sparingly for:

- Premium details
- Scripture markers
- Decorative lines
- Verified badges

Avoid bright neon orange or excessive gold.

6. Dark Mode

Dark mode can be included later or in V1 if development allows.

Suggested dark mode feel:

- Deep charcoal background
- Warm cream text
- Muted saffron accents
- Minimal bright colors

Dark mode should remain readable and calm.

7. Typography

Typography should support:

- English
- Hindi
- Sanskrit
- Roman transliteration

Recommended typography structure:

English

Modern serif or humanist sans-serif for titles.

Clean sans-serif for body text.

Hindi/Sanskrit

Readable Devanagari font.

The Devanagari typography should feel elegant and not compressed.

Scripture

Scripture text should receive special treatment.

Example:

- Larger font

- More line spacing
 - Centered or well-contained layout
 - Clear distinction from commentary
-

8. Typography Hierarchy

Recommended hierarchy:

H1 — Main page title

H2 — Major section

H3 — Subsection

Body Large — Introductory text

Body — Main reading text

Caption — Source, metadata, notes

Scripture — Dedicated style

Translation — Dedicated style

Commentary — Dedicated style

AI Output — Dedicated but neutral style

9. Layout Grid

Desktop:

- Maximum content width around 1200–1280 px
- Reading width around 700–800 px
- Wide cards where needed
- Generous whitespace

Tablet:

- Two-column layouts where suitable

Mobile:

- Single-column
- Large tap areas
- Sticky navigation where useful

10. Header Design

Desktop header:

Logo

Learn

Scriptures

Explore ▼

Ask Dharma

Search

EN / हिन्दी

Library

Profile

The header should remain simple.

Possible sticky behavior:

Header stays visible while scrolling.

11. Explore Dropdown

Explore menu may contain:

- Deities
- Mantras
- Festivals
- Traditions
- Philosophy

This reduces clutter in the top navigation.

12. Mobile Navigation

Recommended mobile bottom navigation:

Home
Learn
Search
Ask
Library

Additional pages through hamburger menu.

The Ask button may have slightly stronger visual emphasis.

13. Homepage UX

Homepage layout:

Hero

Headline:

Understand Sanatan Dharma through trusted sources.

Supporting text:

Learn scriptures, philosophy, traditions, mantras, festivals and spiritual concepts in simple English and Hindi.

Actions:

Start Learning

Ask Dharma

Large search:

What would you like to understand?

14. Homepage Hero Visual

Recommended style:

Subtle modern illustration inspired by:

- Temple geometry
- Sacred manuscripts
- Deepa
- Lotus
- Mandala geometry
- Sunrise
- Indian architecture

Avoid overcrowded imagery.

The visual should support the content rather than dominate it.

15. Start Your Journey Section

Use four cards:

New to Sanatan Dharma

Start from the basics.

Read Bhagavad Gita

Explore chapters and verses.

Explore Scriptures

Discover major texts.

Ask Dharma

Ask questions in simple language.

Cards should include:

- Small icon
- Title
- Description
- Clear action

16. Core Concepts Section

Display concept cards:

- Dharma
- Karma
- Atman
- Brahman
- Moksha
- Samsara
- Bhakti
- Yoga

Each card:

Concept name
One-line meaning
Explore →

Avoid too much information inside cards.

17. Daily Shloka Card

Design:

Large centered Sanskrit verse.

Below:

- Transliteration
- Translation
- Reference

Actions:

- Read explanation
- Bookmark
- Share

Example layout:

Daily Shloka

[Sanskrit]

[Transliteration]

[Meaning]

Bhagavad Gita 2.47

Read Explanation

18. Trust Section

A dedicated trust area should visually communicate accuracy.

Possible heading:

Learn with context, not confusion.

Three principles:

Scripture

Original source.

Commentary

Clearly attributed interpretation.

Explanation

Simple modern explanation.

A fourth badge:

AI

AI-generated answers always labeled.

19. Learn Page UX

The Learn landing page should feel like a learning dashboard.

Possible sections:

- Start Here
 - Beginner Path
 - Core Concepts
 - Popular Questions
 - Continue Learning
 - Recommended Next Step
-

20. Learning Path Design

Display paths as a sequence.

Example:

1. What is Sanatan Dharma?
✓ Completed
2. Dharma
✓ Completed
3. Karma
Current
4. Atman
Locked / Next
5. Brahman

Progress should be visible but not gamified excessively.

21. Concept Page UX

Example page:

Karma

Top section:

Karma

कर्म

A simple explanation of the concept.

Tabs or sections:

- Overview
- Scripture
- Interpretations
- Related Topics
- Sources

For mobile, use stacked sections instead of too many tabs.

22. Beginner and Deep View

A useful feature:

Toggle:

Simple | Deeper

Simple mode:

- Short explanation
- Examples
- Key points

Deeper mode:

- Sanskrit terminology
- Scripture references
- Philosophical differences
- Commentary

This could become a distinctive learning feature.

23. Scripture Library Design

Scripture landing page:

Cards grouped by category.

Example:

Shruti

Vedas

Upanishads

Itihasa

Ramayana

Mahabharata

Other Important Texts

Bhagavad Gita

Puranas

Yoga Sutras

Each card should show:

- Name
- Sanskrit name
- Short description
- Content status
- Explore button

24. Bhagavad Gita Main Page

Hero:

Bhagavad Gita

श्रीमद्भगवद्गीता

Short introduction.

Actions:

- Start Reading
- Continue Reading
- Explore Chapters

Below:

18 chapter cards.

25. Chapter Card Design

Example:

Chapter 2

Sankhya Yoga

सांख्य योग

72 Verses

Knowledge, duty and the nature of the Self.

Explore Chapter

26. Chapter Page UX

Top:

Chapter number

Sanskrit name

English title

Short summary

Key themes

Then:

List of verses.

Filters:

- All verses
- Bookmarked
- Important

Search within chapter can be future scope.

27. Verse Reader UX

The verse page should be one of the best-designed experiences in the product.

Recommended order:

Reference

Bhagavad Gita 2.47

Sanskrit

Large readable text.

Transliteration

Smaller but clearly visible.

Word-by-Word

Expandable section.

English Translation

Hindi Translation

Language can switch without leaving the page.

Simple Explanation

Traditional Commentary

Compare Interpretations

Future or V1 depending on scope.

Related Concepts

Sources

28. Verse Reader Controls

Sticky or floating controls:

- Previous verse
- Next verse
- Bookmark
- Share
- Ask Dharma

On mobile:

Bottom action bar.

29. Commentary Design

Commentaries should not be mixed together.

Use cards or accordion blocks.

Example:

Adi Shankaracharya
Advaita Vedanta

[Commentary summary]

[View full commentary](#)

Another:

Ramanujacharya
Vishishtadvaita

[Commentary summary]

This makes interpretive differences visible.

30. Deities Landing Page

Grid of deity cards.

Each card may include:

- Illustration
- Name
- Sanskrit name
- One-line introduction

Example:

Shiva

शिव

Transformation, yoga and consciousness.

Avoid using random or low-quality images.

31. Deity Detail UX

Hero area:

- Name
- Sanskrit name
- High-quality image or illustration
- Short introduction

Sections:

- Overview
 - Meaning and Names
 - Iconography
 - Scriptures
 - Stories
 - Philosophy
 - Mantras
 - Festivals
 - Traditions
 - Sources
-

32. Mantras Landing Page

Search-first design.

Top:

Find a mantra

Categories:

- Popular
 - Shiva
 - Vishnu
 - Krishna
 - Devi
 - Ganesha
 - Hanuman
 - Peace
 - Meditation
 - Vedic
-

33. Mantra Detail Page

Recommended structure:

Name

Sanskrit

Transliteration

Pronunciation

Audio button — future

Meaning

Context

Source

Traditional usage

Associated deity

Related festival

Related scripture

Bookmark

34. Festival Landing Page

Top section:

Upcoming Festivals

Use large cards for near-term festivals.

Below:

- Major Festivals
 - Browse by Month
 - Browse by Deity
 - Browse by Tradition
-

35. Festival Detail Design

Hero:

Festival name

Hindi/Sanskrit name

Date

Illustration

Sections:

- Meaning
- Why It Is Celebrated
- Traditional Stories
- Practices
- Regional Variations
- Spiritual Significance
- Related Scriptures
- Related Deities

36. Ask Dharma UX

Ask Dharma should feel focused and trustworthy.

Main page:

Ask Dharma

What would you like to understand?

[Input box]

Ask

Suggested prompts:

- What is Dharma?
 - Explain Bhagavad Gita 2.47
 - What is Moksha?
 - Why is Diwali celebrated?
-

37. AI Chat Message Design

User message:

Simple chat bubble.

AI response:

Not only one block of text.

Instead:

Short Answer

Scriptural Basis

Explanation

Different Interpretations

Sources

Explore Next

This creates a structured learning experience.

38. AI Trust Indicators

AI answers should visibly show:

AI-generated explanation

If sources were used:

Based on 4 verified sources

Clicking this opens source details.

39. AI Follow-Up UX

After every answer:

Suggested follow-up questions.

Example:

Explore further

- How is Karma different from Dharma?
- What is Karma Yoga?
- Which Gita verses discuss Karma?

40. Search UX

Search page should have one large search input.

Filters:

- All
- Concepts
- Scriptures
- Verses
- Deities
- Mantras
- Festivals

Each result should indicate type.

Example:

VERSE

Bhagavad Gita 2.47

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते...

Related to Karma Yoga

41. Search Suggestions

As the user types:

kar

Karma
Concept

Karma Yoga
Concept

Bhagavad Gita 2.47
Verse

Chapter 3 – Karma Yoga
Scripture

42. My Library UX

Sections:

- Continue Learning
- Saved Verses
- Saved Mantras
- Saved Concepts
- Reading History

Use simple cards.

Avoid building a complicated dashboard too early.

43. Authentication UX

Do not force login immediately.

Login should be triggered when needed.

Example:

User clicks Bookmark.

Modal:

Save this verse

Create a free account to save verses and continue your learning later.

Options:

- Continue with Google
 - Continue with Apple
 - Continue with Email
-

44. Profile UX

Simple settings page.

Sections:

- Account
 - Language
 - Appearance
 - Notifications
 - Privacy
 - Logout
-

45. Language Switching

Global control:

EN | हिन्दी

When switched:

- UI language changes
- Page content changes
- User stays on equivalent page

Example:

User is reading Karma in English.

They switch to Hindi.

The Hindi version of Karma should open, not the homepage.

46. Hindi UX

Hindi should have equal visual quality.

Important requirements:

- Good Devanagari fonts
 - Proper line spacing
 - Avoid cramped cards
 - Correct punctuation
 - No awkward machine translation
-

47. Sanskrit UX

Sanskrit should receive special typography.

Verse text should have:

- Generous line height
 - Large font
 - Correct Devanagari
 - Copy button
 - Transliteration below
-

48. Cards

Recommended card styles:

Learning Card

Topic + progress.

Scripture Card

Text + category.

Concept Card

Name + short meaning.

Festival Card

Date + festival.

Mantra Card

Name + deity/category.

Source Card

Source information.

Cards should remain visually consistent.

49. Buttons

Primary:

Filled saffron/orange.

Examples:

- Start Learning
- Ask Dharma
- Continue Reading

Secondary:

Outlined or neutral.

Examples:

- View Sources
- Learn More

Text actions:

- Bookmark
 - Share
 - Compare
-

50. Icons

Use simple modern icons.

Possible concepts:

- Book
- Bookmark
- Search
- Lotus
- Chat
- Calendar
- User
- Language
- Play
- Audio

Do not overuse religious symbols as generic interface icons.

51. Religious Symbols

Symbols such as Om should be used carefully.

Do not use sacred symbols as:

- Delete buttons
- Menu buttons
- Loading indicators
- Decorative clutter

Use them only where culturally appropriate.

52. Image Strategy

Use:

- High-quality original illustrations
- Licensed photography
- Carefully selected public-domain art
- Custom iconography

Avoid:

- AI images pretending to be historical artifacts
 - Low-resolution deity images
 - Watermarked images
 - Random internet images
-

53. Illustration Style

Recommended:

Modern Indian editorial illustration.

Characteristics:

- Soft
 - Elegant
 - Respectful
 - Detail without clutter
 - Historically inspired where appropriate
-

54. Animation

Animations should be subtle.

Good:

- Fade
- Slide
- Soft hover
- Smooth page transition
- Card elevation

Avoid:

- Flashy particle effects
 - Excessive spinning
 - Constant movement
 - Heavy religious animation
-

55. Loading States

Use simple skeleton loaders.

Example:

Scripture card loading.

AI answer loading.

Do not use sacred symbols as spinning loaders.

56. Error States

Example:

We couldn't load this verse.

Try again.

If a source is unavailable:

This source is temporarily unavailable.

Avoid vague error messages.

57. Empty States

My Library:

You haven't saved anything yet.

Explore Bhagavad Gita or save a concept to build your library.

Button:

Explore

58. Accessibility Requirements

Target WCAG 2.1 AA where possible.

Important:

- Keyboard navigation
 - Screen reader labels
 - Alt text
 - Good contrast
 - Visible focus states
 - Large tap targets
 - Text resizing
 - Semantic HTML
-

59. Mobile-First Requirements

Mobile must not feel like a smaller desktop site.

Important mobile UX:

- One-column content
 - Sticky bottom navigation
 - Large buttons
 - Verse text readable without zoom
 - Expandable source sections
 - Simplified filters
 - Easy language switch
-

60. Desktop Experience

Desktop can provide:

- Side navigation on deep pages
 - More related content
 - Wider chapter navigation
 - Split layouts
 - Sidebar sources
 - Better compare-commentary layouts
-

61. Recommended Homepage Wireframe

HEADER

HERO

Headline

Description

Start Learning

Ask Dharma

Search

START YOUR JOURNEY

4 cards

CORE CONCEPTS

Concept cards

BHAGAVAD GITA

Featured section

DAILY SHLOKA

EXPLORE

Scriptures / Deities / Mantras / Festivals

UPCOMING FESTIVAL

ASK DHARMA

WHY TRUST US

FOOTER

62. Recommended Verse Page Wireframe

HEADER

Breadcrumb

Bhagavad Gita 2.47

Sanskrit Verse

Transliteration

English / Hindi toggle

Translation

Word-by-word meaning

Simple Explanation

Commentaries

Related Concepts

Ask Dharma

Sources

Previous Verse | Next Verse

63. Recommended AI Page Wireframe

HEADER

ASK DHARMA

Large input

Suggested Questions

Question

Short Answer

Scriptural Basis

Explanation

Different Views

Sources

Related Questions

Input

64. Recommended Design System Components

Create reusable components for:

- Header
- Footer
- Buttons
- Input
- Search
- Cards
- Tabs
- Accordion
- Modal
- Language switcher
- Scripture block
- Translation block
- Commentary card
- Source card
- AI response
- Badge
- Breadcrumb
- Progress bar
- Tooltip
- Empty state
- Error state

65. Design Tokens

The final design system should define:

- Colors
- Typography
- Font sizes
- Spacing
- Border radius

- Shadows
- Icons
- Breakpoints
- Animation duration

These should be centralized so the website remains consistent.

66. Responsive Breakpoints

Possible initial breakpoints:

Mobile: up to 767 px

Tablet: 768–1023 px

Desktop: 1024 px+

Large desktop: 1440 px+

Final breakpoints should be decided during implementation.

67. UX Priority for V1

Highest priority experiences:

1. Homepage
2. Learn
3. Concept page
4. Bhagavad Gita
5. Verse reader
6. Search
7. Ask Dharma
8. Login
9. My Library

Secondary:

- Deity pages
- Mantras
- Festivals

This order should guide implementation.

68. V1 Design Scope

Must design:

- Homepage
 - Learn landing
 - Concept detail
 - Learning path
 - Scriptures landing
 - Bhagavad Gita
 - Chapter
 - Verse reader
 - Deities landing/detail
 - Mantras landing/detail
 - Festivals landing/detail
 - Search
 - Ask Dharma
 - Login/signup
 - My Library
 - Profile
 - Source display
 - Mobile navigation
-

69. UX Success Criteria

The design should succeed if a first-time user can:

- Understand what the product does within seconds
 - Find beginner learning easily
 - Locate a scripture quickly
 - Understand one Gita verse without confusion
 - Ask an AI question
 - See where the answer came from
 - Switch language easily
 - Save useful content
 - Continue later
-

70. Key Differentiating UX

The website should visually separate:

Scripture

Translation

Commentary

Modern Explanation

AI Explanation

This separation should be obvious without requiring users to understand technical terms.

That transparency can become one of the strongest parts of the product.

71. Status

UI/UX Design Specification:

Initial Version Complete

Defined:

- Visual direction
- Colors
- Typography
- Navigation
- Homepage
- Learn
- Scripture reader
- Bhagavad Gita
- Deities
- Mantras
- Festivals
- AI interface
- Search
- Accounts
- Mobile
- Desktop
- Accessibility
- Design system
- Core wireframes

Next document:

Technical Requirements Document